

NAMIBIA

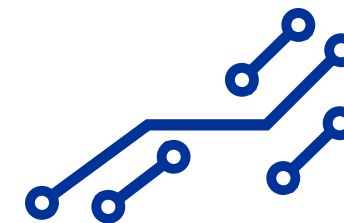
DATA CENTER MARKET BRIEFING

A strategic overview of the data center
investment opportunity in Namibia

A Xalam Analytics Country Report

January 2026



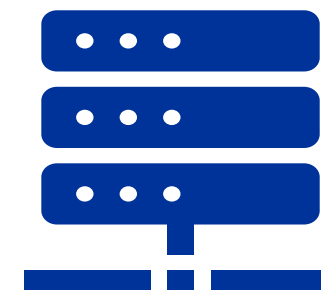


This report is part of a series of market briefs developed by Xalam Analytics at the behest of Digital Investment Facility (DIF) under the Data Governance in Africa Initiative, on the data center market opportunity in sub-Saharan Africa (“SSA”). This analysis aims to provide key insights into market demand and supply patterns for data center markets, business landscape, regulatory impact and investment returns. The research aims to provide potential investors and stakeholders with the latest information on the data center market in the SSA region.

This country review is based on our assessment of information and data as available to our research. It is further underpinned by our understanding of the marketplace along with market data and insights collected through continuous research. The numbers and estimates in this report are derived from a mix of sources, including estimates from Xalam Analytics’ economic models, data providers, regulator data and other sources as may be indicated.

This report is prepared with funds from the [Data Governance in Africa Initiative](#), a project financed by the European Union, Germany, Belgium, Estonia, Finland and France under the [Digital for Development \(D4D\) Hub](#). Its contents are the sole responsibility of Xalam Analytics and do not necessarily reflect the views of the funders.

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The Namibia data center investment case

A growing regional logistics and connectivity hub and ambitious green hydrogen infrastructure plans are making Namibia increasingly attractive to data center development



THE OPPORTUNITY

- **Relative political and economic stability**, with GDP growth averaging 3-4% per year.
- **Namibia's proximity to South Africa** makes it a suitable alternative for customers looking for a presence in Southern Africa. Namibia borders nearly all the countries in Southern Africa.
- **Namibia is a regional logistics hub**, with some of the best ports and road infrastructure in Africa.
- **A key market for the development of renewable energy sources**; Namibia has extensive plans for green hydrogen development and has some of the world's highest solar radiation levels.

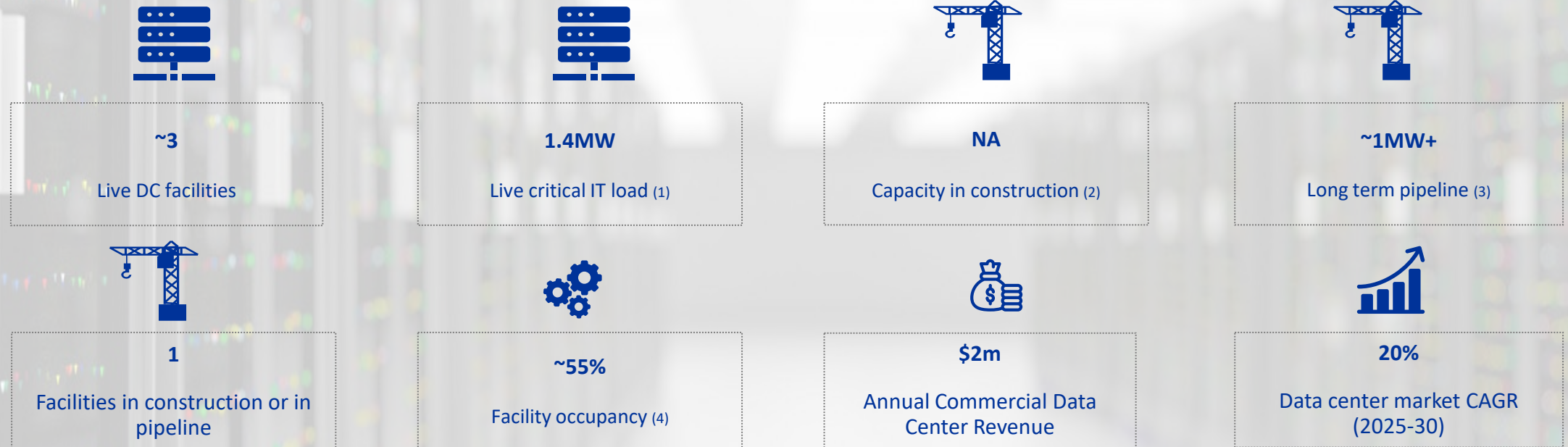


CHALLENGES & RISKS

- **Relatively small population and economy**, limiting the size of the data center opportunity relative to other countries in the region.
- High poverty levels and high unemployment.
- **Moderately high energy prices** when compared with some of its Southern African peers.
- Concentrated fiber market leading to **relatively high bandwidth costs**.

Namibia data center market overview

Estimates as of 2025



(1) Capacity that is active, under lease or readily available for lease by third-party customers.

(2) IT load capacity from facilities currently in construction; construction has broken ground; ongoing civil works, installation and commissioning phases are in progress.

(3) Facilities explicitly announced or listed as in development. Some execution phases have been initiated (e.g. land control, energy supply commitments, etc.), but no actual civil works have been undertaken. Capacity expected to be available by the end of 2030.

(4) Percent of available capacity that is effectively being used by third party customers.

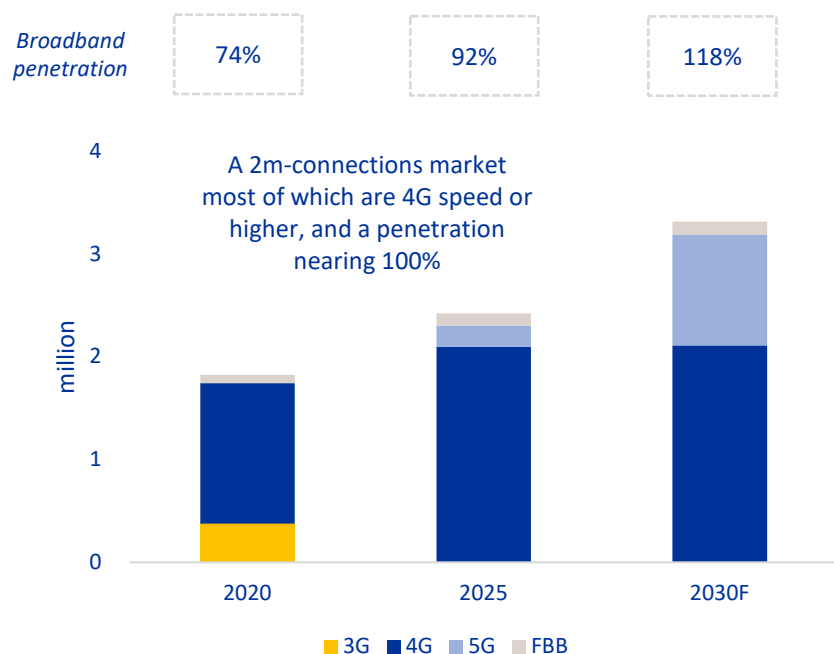
Sources: Xalam Analytics estimates, provider data

Key drivers of demand for data centers

An opportunity to expand a burgeoning hosting and cloud infrastructure in an increasingly mature digital environment

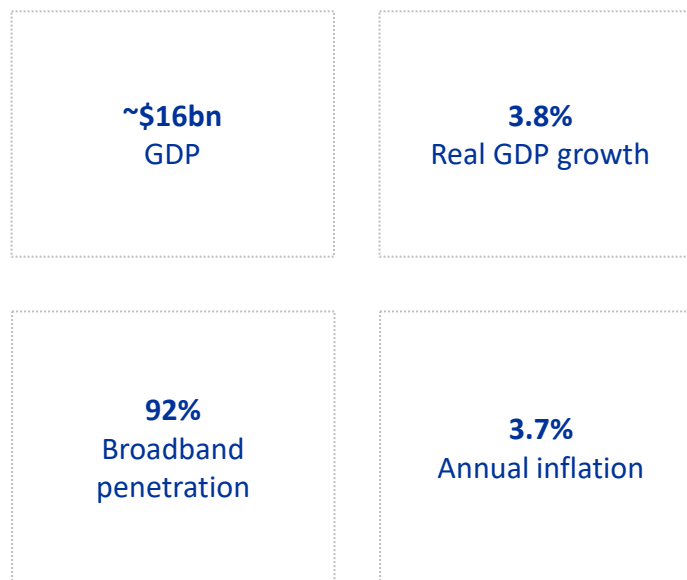
A mature broadband market

Namibia broadband connections by type - million



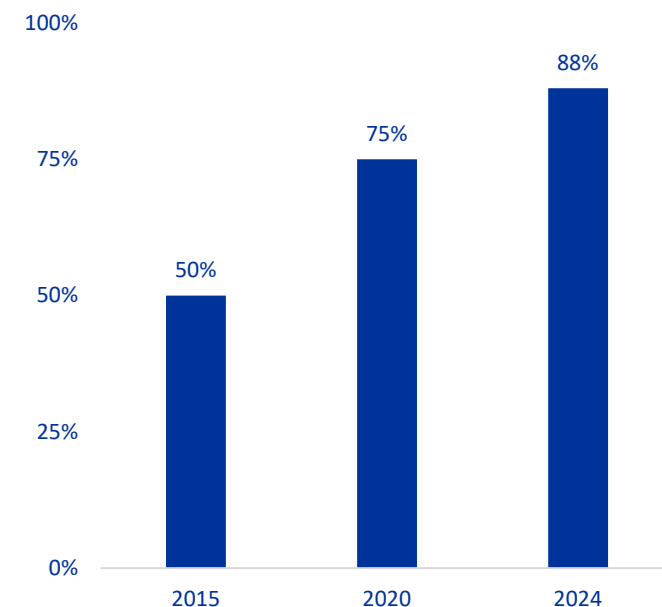
A stable, mostly predictable economy

Namibia key indicators - 2025



Accelerated digital infrastructure build

Namibia 4G network coverage - % of the population



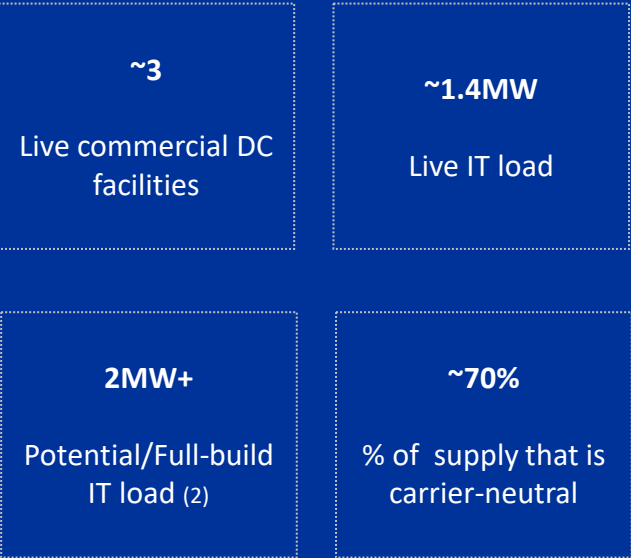
Sources: IMF, CRAN and provider data, Xalam Analytics estimates

State of data center supply

While small, Namibia’s data center capacity base has grown steadily and is already robust relative to the country’s economy and population size

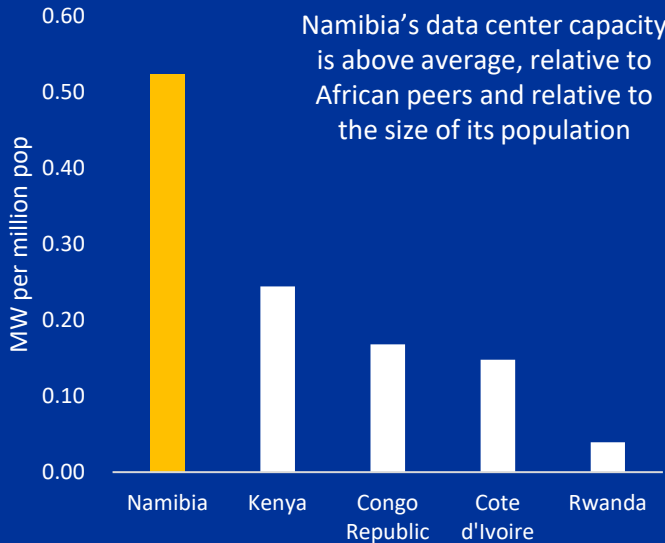
Namibia data center supply – 2025E

Sample market indicators (1)



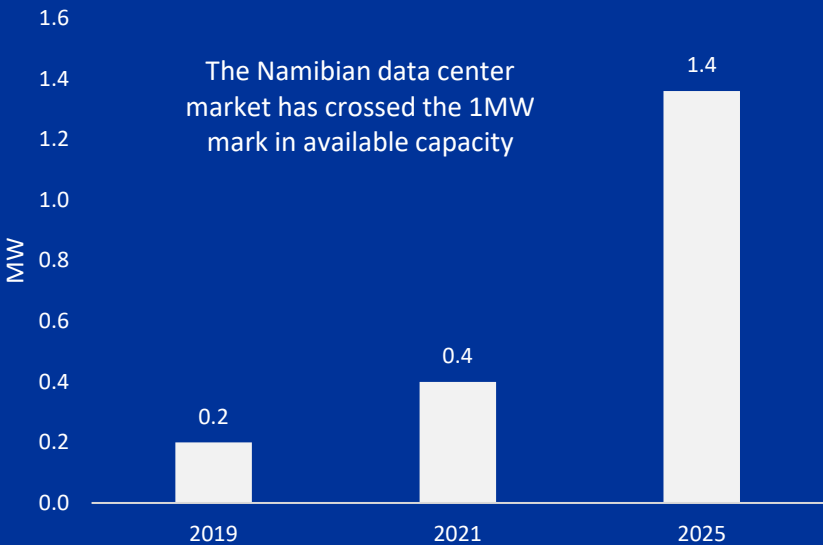
Namibia vs. Sub-Saharan Africa peers

Critical IT load – MW per million population



Namibia data center market – evolution of live supply

Critical IT load - in MW



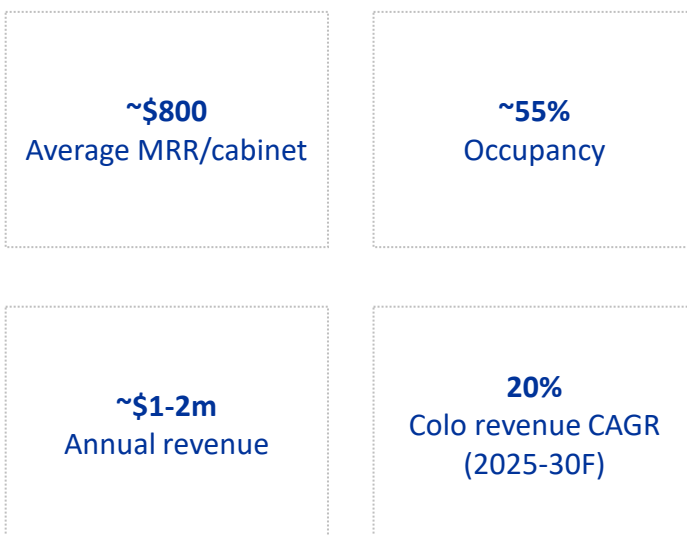
(1)Numbers are rounded up (2) Potential/Full-build load is facility capacity assuming that all phases of development have been completed. Additional CapEx would be needed to make the residual capacity operational.
Sources: Xalam Analytics estimates, provider data

Data center market outlook

Namibia's data center colocation market is set to triple by 2030, reaching \$3m in annual revenue

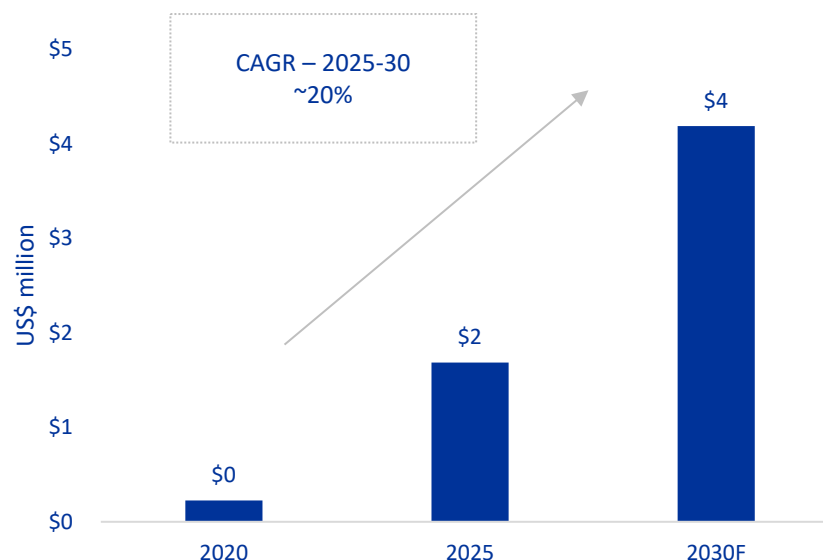
Namibia – Data center market economics – 2025

Sample market indicators



Namibia annual commercial colocation revenue

US\$ million



A small, but growing market



- Namibia is a small colocation market, generating ~\$1.2m per year in revenue.
- The market is expected to triple in size by 2030, reaching \$3m, mostly the result of increased occupancy rates within existing facilities.

Sources: Xalam Analytics estimates, provider data

Key data center market players

The market is dominated by telcos and the Paratus carrier-neutral facility, with limited competition

Telcos



Focused on mobility and fiber
- colocation is an adjacent opportunity.

Carrier-neutral



Fiberco managing its facility on a
carrier-neutral basis

Limited competition

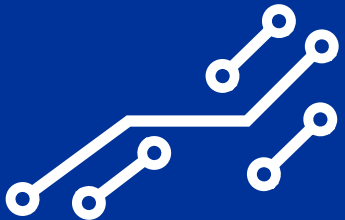


- Telcos and fiber infracos dominate the market.
- Paratus manages the only built-for-purpose data center in Namibia. The other two facilities are hybrid facilities used mainly for internal purposes.
- Namibia has yet to see the introduction of a carrier-neutral player, likely the result of its proximity to South Africa.
- Namibia's energy endowments and the development of renewable power sources such as hydrogen give it AI cluster potential over the long run.

Sources: Xalam Analytics estimates, provider data



GLOSSARY & KEY DEFINITIONS



Key definitions

Data center	While there are a variety of definitions for data centers, this market review is focused on commercial facilities , that is, facilities that lease colocation white space and power capacity to third-party customers on open, commercial terms, and in exchange for a fee. Captive facilities (bank data centers, telco switch sites and similar) are excluded from this assessment. Estimates focus on facilities at Tier II standard and above, unless otherwise indicated. Where applicable, these estimates include cloud hyperscaler self-built facilities.
Live critical IT load	Capacity that is active, under lease or readily available for lease.
Full build capacity	Data center facilities are typically built in phases; the full-build capacity is capacity assuming all potential phases of build have been completed and are live.
Capacity in construction	Facilities that have broken ground; ongoing civil works, installation and commissioning phases.
Pipeline	Facilities explicitly announced or listed as in development. Some execution phases have been initiated (e.g. land acquisition, power supply commitments, etc.), but no actual civil works have been undertaken.
Carrier-neutral	Facilities not specifically affiliated to a connectivity or cloud vendor, with capacity available to all third-party customers, on equal commercial terms, without explicit or implicit constraints or favoritism. This market review uses a loose definition for carrier-neutral, referring to facilities that are purely carrier-neutral, recognized by the market or effectively managed as such.

Glossary

Below are some of the key abbreviations used in this report

AI	Artificial Intelligence
ASN	Autonomous System Number
bn	billion
CAGR	Compound Annual Growth Rate
CapEx	Capital Expenditures
CDN	Content Delivery Network
Colo	Colocation
DC	Data Center
DIF	Digital Investment Facility
EAC	East African Community
EU	European Union
F	Forecast
FBB	Fixed Broadband
FDI	Foreign Direct Investment
FX	Foreign Exchange
GDP	Gross Domestic Product
GDPR	General Data Protection Regulation
ICT	Information, Communications and Technology
ISP	Internet Service Provider
IPP	Independent Power Producer
IT	Information Technology

kW	Kilowatt
kWh	Kilowatt Hour
LLM	Large Language Models
m	million
MNC	Multinational Corporation
MNO	Mobile Network Operator
MRR	Monthly Recurring Revenue
MSP	Managed Service Provider
MW	Megawatts
NDC	National Data Center
OEM	Original Equipment Manufacturer
POP	Point of Presence
PUE	Power Usage Effectiveness
RFS	Ready For Service
SEZ	Special Economic Zone
SSA	Sub-Saharan Africa
USD	US dollar
PUE	Power Usage Effectiveness
RFS	Ready For Service
SSA	Sub-Saharan Africa
YE	Year end



Learn more:

<https://d4dhub.eu/initiatives/data-governance-in-africa>

